Product Teardown: peakflo

Focus: AP/AR automation and agentic workflows

Company: Peakflo, YC W22

Goal: Map friction in P2P and I2C and prioritise three agentic fixes

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Product overview: two workflows, one ledger

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P2P

Procure-to-Pay

Automates purchase requests, multi-level approvals, PO creation, three-way invoice matching and payment execution in a single workflow.

I2C

Invoice-to-Cash

Manages invoice generation, delivery, collections follow-up, payment reconciliation and cash posting, reducing Days Sales Outstanding.

ERP

ERP integrations

Bidirectional sync with NetSuite, Xero, QuickBooks and SAP, connecting invoice status, payment data and general ledger entries.

Market context

Mid-market finance teams (**$5M to $500M revenue**) in Southeast Asia and India still process invoices through **email chains, spreadsheets and manual approval routing.**

Southeast Asia | India | Mid-market | AI-native automation

Key Insights:

This creates **reconciliation backlogs** at month-end.

It creates **late payment penalties** when approvals stall.

It leaves **zero real-time cash visibility.** Peakflo's thesis is to close these gaps with AI-native automation.

Personas 1 of 2: approvals and cash

P

Priya, AP Manager

Finance Lead, 150-person company

Goal: process 200+ vendor invoices monthly, zero duplicate payments, full audit trail.

Pain: chases approvals via email for 3 to 5 days per invoice; no SLA enforcement.

Metric: invoice processing time, on-time payment rate, approval cycle time.

R

Rahul, CFO

Chief Financial Officer

Goal: real-time cash flow visibility; spot early payment discounts.

Pain: ERP dashboard shows 8-hour stale data; misses 2 to 3% early payment discounts regularly.

Metric: DSO, cash conversion cycle, working capital efficiency.

Personas 2 of 2: supplier and ops

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A

Arjun, Vendor / Supplier

Accounts Receivable, supplier side

Goal: track invoice status without calling; get paid within agreed terms.

Pain: no self-serve portal; re-submits invoices when there is no response, causing duplicates.

Metric: payment cycle time, dispute resolution rate.

S

Sneha, Finance Ops Analyst

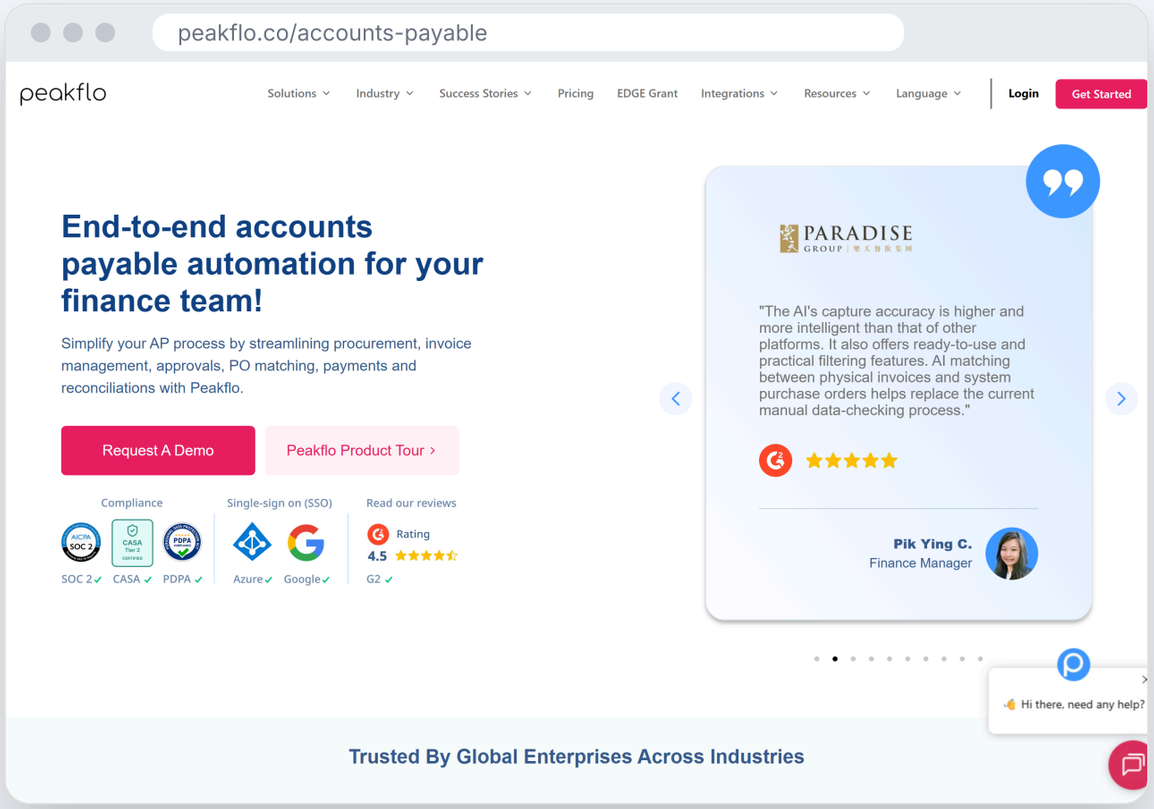
Operations Analyst

Goal: monthly reconciliation completed within 2 days of period close.

Pain: manually exports ERP data and cross-references bank statements in Excel every month-end.

Metric: reconciliation time, exception rate, close cycle duration.

Product screen: accounts payable



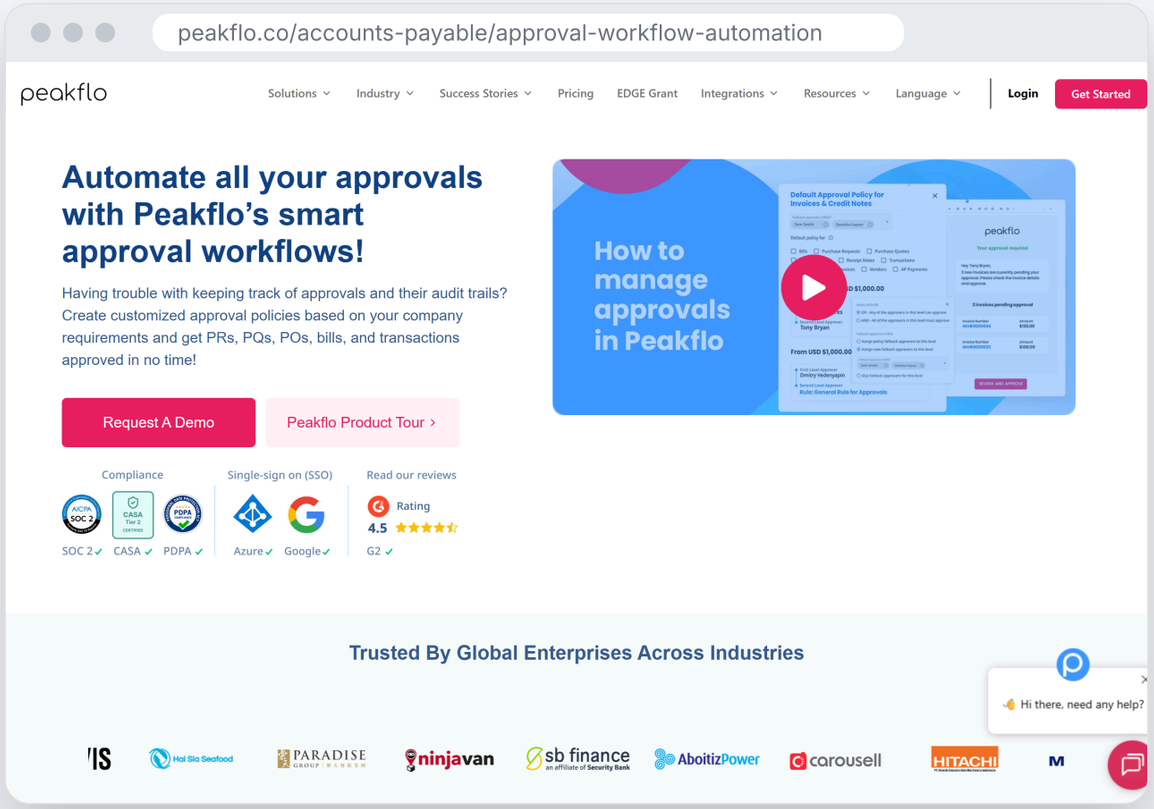
The AP page sells **end-to-end AP automation:** procurement, invoice management, approvals, PO matching, payments and reconciliations.

It names the buyer problem as email-based approval chasing, which is exactly **Priya's pain.**

Capture, approval, matching and payment are sold as separate features. **The hand-offs between them are where the as-is cycle still loses days.**

Solution: Teardown lens: judge the product on the hand-offs, not the feature list.

Product screen: approval workflows



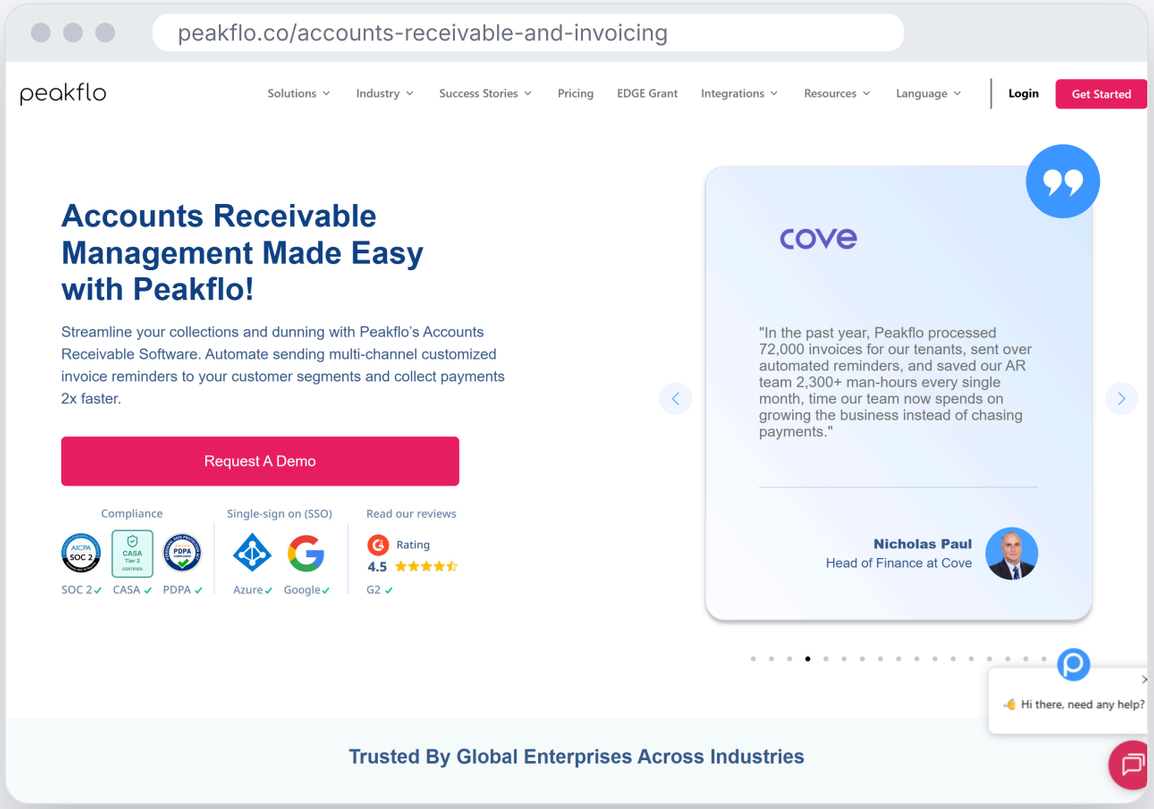
Peakflo positions approvals as **customised policies** for PRs, PQs, POs, bills and transactions, with an audit trail.

Its own page lists companies "using emails, various tools and spreadsheets to chase approvers" as a fit. That is the **same pain in my friction map.**

The page describes who approves, not what happens when an approver is slow. No escalation or SLA is shown.

Solution: Proposed fix P0: auto-escalate when an approval SLA is breached.

Product screen: accounts receivable



The AR page promises collections and dunning with **multi-channel customised invoice reminders.**

A customer testimonial on the page speaks to automated reminders and hours saved for the AR team.

This is the I2C side of my map, where the as-is **DSO sits at 45 to 60 days** because of customer delay and manual follow-ups.

Solution: The same escalation idea applies to overdue invoices, a follow-on to P0.

AS-IS: Procure-to-Pay

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01
Request + approval
Purchase request by email (Day 0), manager approval by email reply (Day 1 to 3).

→

02
Manual PO
PO created by hand in the ERP. Day 3 to 4.

→

03
Vendor PDF
Invoice arrives by email. Day 4 to 6.

→

04
Manual matching
PO matched by hand. Day 6 to 8.

→

05
Email approval
Multi-level approval over email. Day 8 to 14.

→

06
Pay + reconcile
Manual payment schedule (Day 14 to 18), month-end reconciliation (Day 30).

14 to 21 days average cycle time | 8 to 12 manual touchpoints per invoice | 0% automated SLA enforcement

AS-IS: Invoice-to-Cash

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01
Create + send
Invoice created in ERP (Day 0), sent via email (Day 1).

→

02
Customer delay
Customer internal delay. Day 5 to 20.

→

03
Manual follow-up
Calls and emails. Day 20 to 40.

→

04
Payment
Payment received. Day 40 to 60.

→

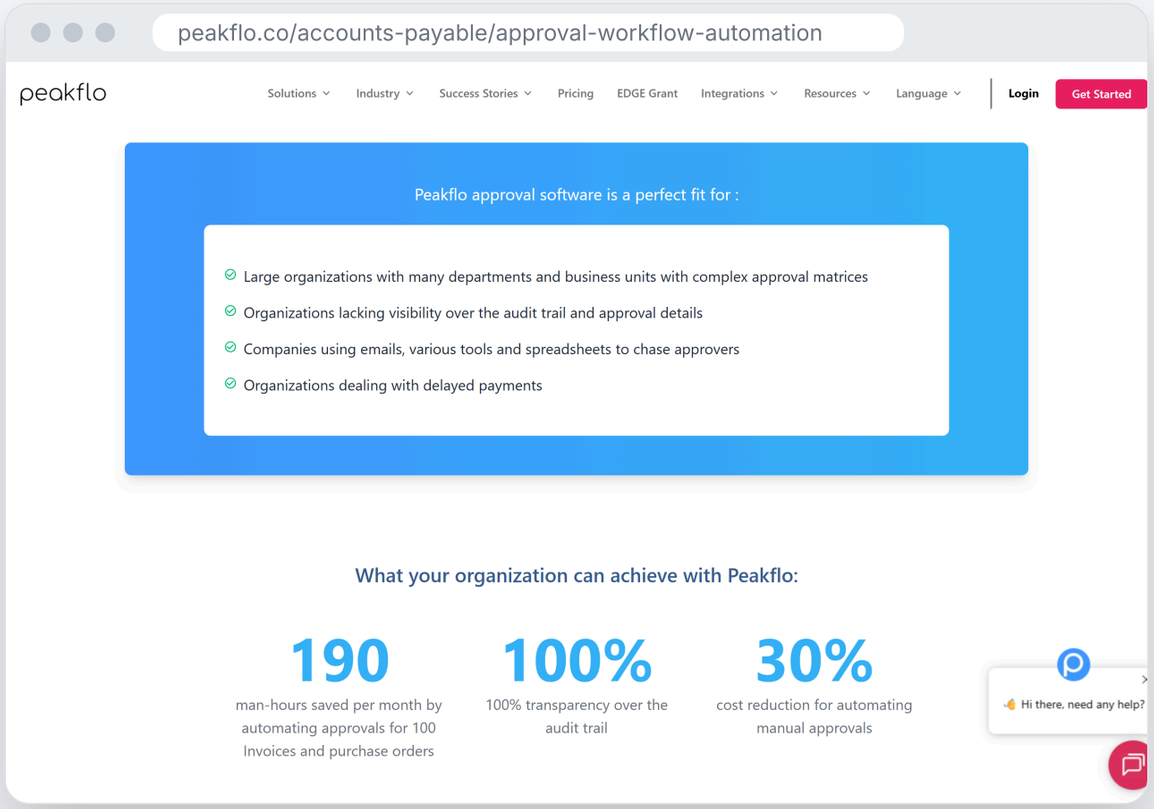
05
Manual matching
Invoice matched by hand. Day 60.

→

06
Spreadsheet recon
Reconciled in spreadsheets at month-end.

45 to 60 days average DSO | 3 to 5 manual follow-ups per invoice | 8hr+ ERP data lag for the CFO

Friction 1 (Critical): no approval escalation



Invoices stall when approvers are **on leave, travelling or overloaded.** No trigger fires when an SLA window is breached.

Root cause: routing is static. Approvers are assigned but no time-bound escalation path is enforced.

Impact: 3 to 5 day delay per invoice. At 200 invoices a month that is 600 to 1,000 delayed processing days, raising DPO and straining vendors.

Friction 2 (High): duplicate invoices

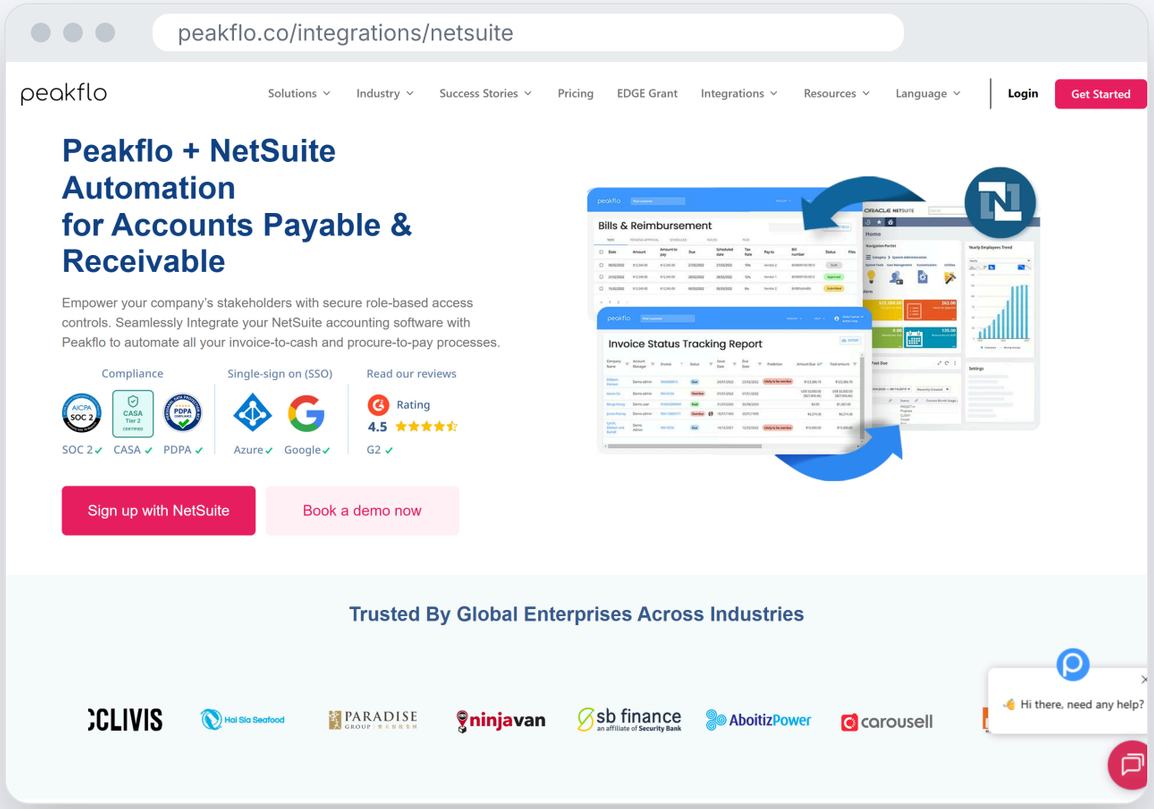


Vendors re-submit invoices after timeouts or errors. Duplicates are often **caught at month-end, weeks after payment.**

Root cause: ingestion relies on manual PO lookup, not multi-field similarity on vendor ID, amount, date range and line-item hash.

Impact: industry duplicate rate of 0.1 to 0.5% of volume. At $10M monthly payables, that is $10,000 to $50,000 overpaid a month.

Friction 3 (Medium): batch ERP sync



Status, payment and approval updates sync to the ERP **hourly or end-of-day,** so decisions use data 1 to 8 hours old.

Root cause: the sync layer is batch-based; no webhook fires when an invoice changes status.

Impact: 2 to 3% early payment discounts missed (windows are about 48 hours). At $2M monthly eligible payables, $40,000 to $60,000 uncaptured a year.

Proposed: three agentic fixes

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P0

Auto-escalation trigger

On SLA breach (default 24h) an LLM writes an escalation with invoice context; approval re-routes via API; email, Slack and WhatsApp notify; everything is logged for audit. Target: 60% shorter approval cycle.

P1

Duplicate detection

On ingestion, an embedding match on vendor ID, amount, date (plus or minus 7 days) and line-item hash. Scores of 85% or more go to an exception queue. Target: 94% lower duplicate rate.

P2

Event-driven ERP sync

Every status change fires a webhook to the ERP, with an idempotent retry queue and audit log. Target: ERP lag from 8 hours to under 2 minutes.

Prioritised on RICE (Proposed)

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Fix	Reach	Impact	Confidence	Effort	RICE
Auto-escalation (P0)	High, all AP users	High, unblocks the cycle	High, SLA data already tracked	Medium, 3 to 4 weeks	240
Duplicate detection (P1)	Medium, AP and Finance	High, prevents overpayments	High, embedding match is proven	Medium, 3 to 4 weeks	200
Event-driven sync (P2)	High, ERP users	Medium, visibility only	Medium, ERP rate limits vary	High, 6 to 8 weeks	120

Proposed roadmap: 4 weeks to pilot

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W1

Phase 1: Discovery (weeks 1-2)

Structured sessions with AP managers. Map the invoice lifecycle in at least 3 accounts and set baselines for approval time, duplicate rate and ERP lag. Non-negotiable before building.

W3

Phase 2: PRD (week 3)

Specify trigger conditions, SLA thresholds per tier, notification channels, the audit data model and a rollback for wrongly escalated invoices.

W4

Phase 3: Kickoff (week 4)

Epics and acceptance criteria, baselines instrumented, 2 pilot customers, and an internal staging demo with failure modes tested.

Proposed success metrics

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NORTH STAR METRIC

P0 target: 60% reduction in approval cycle time

Measured against baselines set in the discovery phase, across 2 pilot customers.

L1 METRIC

P1 target: 94% reduction in the duplicate payment rate.

L2 METRIC

P2 target: ERP data lag from 8 hours to under 2 minutes.

Thank you for reading.

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